



APOSTROPHES MASTERCLASS

The Definitive Guide to Mastering the Apostrophe



Today's goal:

Become CONFIDENT with apostrophes.

By the end, you will:



know when to use them



know when NOT to use them



fix apostrophe mistakes confidently



What Is an Apostrophe?

An apostrophe (') has **ONLY TWO** jobs:

1) Missing letters



2) Possession



If it is not doing one of these jobs, it **does NOT** belong.



Job 1: Missing Letters (Contractions)

Examples:

it is → it's

you are → you're

they are → they're

do not → don't

cannot → can't

Job 2: Possession (Ownership)

To show possession,
we usually use **'s**.



Example:



The girl's bag

Singular Possession

One owner → 's



Examples:



the boy's hat



the teacher's desk

Plural Possession

More than one owner:



boys' → boys'

→ If the word ends in s → add apostrophe after s

Example:



'

the
girls'
bags

the
teachers'
lounge

'



IMPORTANT RULE

To show possession, we usually use 's.

★ EXCEPT: ★

Possessive pronouns
do NOT use apostrophes.

~~my his its our~~
~~your her~~
~~their~~

Possessive Pronouns (NO Apostrophes)

❖ These words already show belonging:



Rule:

Possessive pronouns NEVER use apostrophes.

NEVER'

Why This Matters

Compare:

Correct Use

the dog's tail



its tail



Incorrect Use

it's tail



If a word has an apostrophe,
it is **NOT** a possessive pronoun.

ITS vs IT'S

IT'S

IT'S = it is

Example:
It's raining.



ITS

ITS = belonging (NO apostrophe)

Example:
The dog wagged its tail.



~~NEVER~~'

Rule:

ITS NEVER has an apostrophe.

YOUR vs YOU'RE

YOU'RE

YOU'RE = you are

Example:
You're ready.



YOUR

YOUR = belonging

Example:
That is your book.



THEIR vs THERE vs THEY'RE

THEIR

THEIR = belonging



THERE

THERE = place



THEY'RE

THEY'RE = they are



THEY'RE

Only THEY'RE has an apostrophe.

Common Apostrophe Mistakes

NO

DO NOT use apostrophes for plurals.

Wrong 

apple's



Correct 

apples





Editing Practice



Fix the mistakes:

1) Your my
friend.



2) The dogs
tail wagged.



3) Its time
to go.



Challenge Round



FIX THESE:

1) You're
bag is
over there.



2) The cat
licked it's
paws.



3) They're
coming
soon.



Apostrophe Checklist ✓

✦ Before writing an apostrophe, ask:



Missing letters?



Possession?

If NO → don't use it.





Key Takeaway



To show possession,
we usually use 's.



Possessive pronouns
never use apostrophes.



Apostrophes always
have a job.

You Did It!



✦ You now understand apostrophes deeply.

✦ This will improve all your writing.



Practice: Narrative Writing



✦ Fix the apostrophes:

- ✦  The dragon lost it's fire.
- ✦  The hero picked up his sword and its shield.
- ✦  You're friend ran into the forest.



Practice: Dialogue



✦ Correct the apostrophes:

- ✦  1) "Your coming with us," said the captain.
- ✦  2) "Its my turn!" shouted the child.
- ✦  3) "The dogs tail is hurt," she whispered.



Practice: Informative Text



✦ Edit the sentences:

- ✦  1) The planets orbit shows its path around the sun.
- ✦  2) Its important to check facts carefully.
- ✦  3) Each animals habitat protects it's young.



Practice: Instructions

Fix the apostrophes:

- 1) Pick up the tool and place it in it's box.
- 2) Check you're work before submitting.
- 3) The machines safety rules are important.



Practice: Persuasive Writing



Correct the mistakes:

1)



Our schools rules
should protect it's
students.

2)



Your opinion
matters.

3)



Everyone
deserves they're
chance.

Practice: Advertisements

Edit carefully:



1)

Apple's for sale
today!



2)

Its the best deal
you'll find.



3)

Your going to
love this product.

Practice: Reports

Fix the apostrophes:

1)



The animals
habitat helps it's
survival.

2)



The scientists
results were
surprising.

3)



Its behaviour
changes at
night.

Challenge: Mixed Genres

Correct all apostrophe errors:

1)



Your brother
said **its**
raining.

2)



The **girls**
bag is
missing.

3)



Theyre
preparing the
shows costumes.

4)



The **teams**
strategy
worked.